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Unit 1 Aspects of Dramatic Tragedy

Mark scheme

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Version: 1.0 Final Mark Scheme



2 2 1 X L T 0 1 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the Assessment Objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

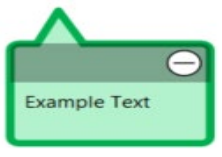
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Red Line		 Toolbar Tooltip: Red Line		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text – text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Unfocused		Toolbar Tooltip: Unfocused		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Factual Inaccuracy		Toolbar Tooltip: Factual Inaccuracy		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The Assessment Objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally-weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello, Desdemona and Iago
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Othello* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the views of women presented in the passage
- aspects of social and military rank
- the different ways in which an audience might respond to the characters in this scene
- tragic ironies: eg at the end of the passage
- references to elemental forces
- invocations to the gods; perhaps tragic over-confidence here
- references to aspects of religious belief.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the relationship of this passage to what has gone before: build up to Othello's entrance
- the structure of the scene: two contrasting sections and Iago's final words
- Iago's dramatic language: riddling, proverbial, sardonic
- Iago's asides, providing a running commentary on the action
- the dramatic role of Cassio
- Desdemona's interaction with Othello
- Othello's dramatic language: assured, rhetorical, exclamatory.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Lear and Cordelia
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *King Lear* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- aspects of fatherhood and the daughter-father relationship
- aspects of and attitudes towards kingship
- cosmic forces represented by the weather – their tragic impact
- religious ideas: eg life and death, heaven and hell, resurrection
- the significant and tragic image of the wheel of fire
- the degree to which Lear is conscious of what is happening around him: his knowledge and self-knowledge
- different possible audience responses to the characters.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the action which preceded this passage
- Lear's dramatic language in this passage: simple, unassertive, comparatively quiet
- echoes and simple repetitions in his speech: eg 'know', 'know not'
- Cordelia's dramatic language: tender, supportive
- her use of terms of healing: eg 'medicine', 'restoration', 'repair'
- Cordelia's references to past events
- some words which are significant within the wider tragedy: eg 'wrong', 'cause', 'weep'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet and Claudius
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Hamlet* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the preceding action: Claudius's plotting
- different possible responses to the two characters
- the political context of international relations
- the extended focus on death, its ominous and tragic significance
- the focus on the off-stage body of Polonius: aspects of crime and punishment
- references to heaven and hell
- acting: both of the main characters are consciously playing a part.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the dialogue between Hamlet and Claudius: in some ways it takes the form of an interrogation and later becomes a battle of wits
- Hamlet's word play, puns and double-meanings, use of mock-logic
- the vocabulary of the world of politics: eg 'progress', convocation', 'politic'
- some darkly comic elements in the passage
- imagery of disease and healing
- the series of exits ultimately leaving Claudius alone on the stage
- the effect of Claudius's final speech, anticipates future events, a sense of gathering pace.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and Mephistopheles
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Doctor Faustus* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the action that preceded this passage
- echoes of the medieval morality plays in the figures of the good and bad angels
- the complex relationship between Faustus and Mephistopheles
- Mephistopheles's twisted reasoning and occasional flattery
- Faustus's internal conflict: his soul as a battleground
- different possible audience reactions to his situation
- the growing sense of the inevitability of his fate.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the significance of the setting in Faustus's study
- the structure of the passage: swift interchange of dialogue leading to longer reflective speeches
- the language of Christian religion
- scholastic dialogue, debate and terminology
- classical references
- Faustus's internal dialogue
- key words within the tragedy: eg 'repent', 'magic', 'despair'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess and Antonio
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues many strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Duchess of Malfi* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- ambition as a central factor in the tragedy
- social rank and social climbing
- aspects of domestic tragedy
- ironic role reversals: the Duchess takes the lead in the wooing
- the degree to which the Duchess is seen as being trapped by her position in society
- different possible responses to Antonio: plain and honest or passive and weak
- the ironic and tragic over-confidence displayed by the Duchess
- the direct reference in the final speech of the passage to the central tragic concepts of pity and fear.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of extended figurative language: developed similes and metaphors
- wider structural contrasts in the play between different characters and scenes: eg between this passage and the previous interview between the Duchess and her brothers
- references to light and darkness
- the language of trade and finance, selling and buying
- visual images: the tomb of the Duchess's first husband
- tragic and dramatic ironies: eg 'Quietus est'
- significant dramatic action in the passage.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to other parts of the play may be more generalised than those from the passage.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘The tragedy of *Death of a Salesman* is driven by self-deception rather than by deception.’

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Salesman* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- possible agreement, perhaps focusing on Willy and his tragic lack of self-knowledge
- evidence of deception: eg Willy’s affair and Biff’s thefts
- Willy’s failure to recognise the real nature of the world in which he lives
- the tragic effects of time: growing old, facing an uncertain future
- a possible argument that Linda is presented as a more clear-sighted character
- the characters of Biff and Happy: evidence of their own self-deception and the degree to which they have a flawed understanding of their father
- the role of a salesman.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the setting – a ‘small, fragile-seeming house’ with its ‘air of the dream’
- the use of stage directions to draw attention to aspects of character
- the structural movement of the play: perhaps Biff’s growth in understanding
- Willy’s monologues and what they reveal about him
- dramatic symbols: eg the stockings
- the effect of Miller’s use of music and other non-verbal dramatic effects
- the tragic and dramatic significance of the Requiem.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘Mitch is a weak and ultimately inadequate figure. He has little impact on the tragedy of *A Streetcar Named Desire*.’

How far do you agree with this view of the way that Mitch is presented in the play?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *A Streetcar Named Desire* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- agreeing and making reference to his generally subordinate position within his group of male friends
- his abandonment of Blanche and thus his contribution to her tragic fall
- an argument that he is another victim of love, and also a victim of Blanche herself
- his courtesy and protectiveness: his genuine care for his mother and, at first, Blanche
- the degree to which he can be seen as gullible and innocent
- the moment in scene six when he suggests that he and Blanche have something in common: they both need somebody
- whether he is protected by Stanley or can be more accurately seen as being his victim.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the pattern of his appearances in the play
- his first words in the play: ‘I’m out’ – suggesting a sort of passivity
- his acting as a foil for Stanley, a dramatic contrast: eg their very different responses to feeling hot and sweaty
- other characters’ views of him
- his final words and actions – he collapses at the card table, defeated
- the degree to which he is also presented as being shaped by the past – his memories of a dead girl
- his often awkward, hesitant way of speaking.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

‘Hedda cannot cope with reality. That is her tragedy.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way that Hedda is presented in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Hedda Gabler* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- an argument that supports the given view, referring to her suicide at the end of the play
- the character of Loevborg – someone who also finds respectable society a restraint, but who reacts in a different way
- Hedda’s frequently expressed frustration
- the mistaken expectations she perhaps had about what marriage to Tesman would bring; her disillusionment
- the limits of her ability to understand other people
- the tragic destruction of her idealism and her dreams.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Hedda’s dramatic language – at times confrontational and often self-absorbed
- the tragic momentum of the play and a sense of a slowly closing trap
- the claustrophobic effect of the stage setting – impression of a staid and conventional social world
- the house as a symbol of Hedda’s attempt to impose her own personality on the world around her
- the dramatic contrast between Hedda and the other female characters
- her physical movements on stage – seemingly always in motion
- symbolic acts of destruction: eg the manuscript.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

The relationship between Vladimir and Estragon is central to the tragedy of *Waiting for Godot*.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Waiting for Godot* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- an argument that supports the given view – their constant presence on stage
- their waiting for Godot – their whole existence is a sort of tragic trap
- the nature of their relationship – operating very much as a pair, a double-act, an uneasy alliance
- similarities and differences between the two characters
- the degree to which they are seen as tragically imprisoned within their relationship
- the effect of time; the uncertainty regarding their past, their essentially unchanging present
- a possible dramatic and tragic contrast with the other pair relationship, that between Pozzo and Lucky.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- echoes, parallels, repetitions in their words and behaviour
- the bare stage setting ('A country road. A tree.') has the effect of focusing our attention on the characters
- the significant amount of time when they are the only two characters on stage
- their physical interaction, occasional clownish behaviour
- their dialogue and the different ways it connects the two characters; the extent to which at times their language seems to disintegrate
- the dramatic effects of silences and stillness: at times conveys impotence and frustration
- the frequency of their use of the pronoun 'we'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the play may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument, here related to significance of aspects of tragedy
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

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Brian Friel: *Translations*

‘*Translations* is a tragedy about characters who are trapped within a place and a time.’

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Translations* through the lens of **tragedy**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- historical contexts: Ireland being subject to an imperial power
- specific problems suffered by Ireland during this period: eg the potato blight
- language itself as a trap: dead and dying languages
- a counter-view that the characters are also trapped through their own weaknesses and the flawed decisions they make
- other relevant elements of tragedy: eg errors of judgement, ‘star-crossed lovers’; lack of self-knowledge
- the familiar potential for tragic conflict within the family unit – not therefore necessarily subject to time or place.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of different languages within the play which set the action in a specific time but also convey a degree of timelessness
- references to specific historical events
- characters’ expressions of frustration due to their circumstances
- the tragic momentum of the action
- the tendency of Hugh and Jimmy to retreat into the past
- ‘translations’ – images and symbols of change set against images of custom and tradition
- the dramatic and symbolic significance of place names.

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